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Pronouns (Antecedents of Pronouns, Personal Pronouns) • Practice 1

Antecedents of Pronouns A pronoun is a word used to take the place of a noun. The noun it substitutes for is called an antecedent.

PRONOUNS AND ANTECEDENTS		
ANTECEDENT	PRONOUN	PRONOUN
Bill raised his trophy in triumph and he smiled.		
PRONOUN	ANTECEDENT	PRONOUN
Waving her hand, the actress greeted her fans.		

Personal Pronouns Personal pronouns refer to (1) the person speaking, (2) the person spoken to, or (3) the person, place, or thing spoken about.

First Person	Second Person	Third Person
I, me, my, mine we, us, our, ours	you, your, yours	he, him, his, she, her, hers, it, its, they, them, their, theirs

Exercise 1 Recognizing Pronouns and Antecedents.

Underline the personal pronoun in each sentence. Then circle its antecedent.

EXAMPLE: The players brought their lunches to the game.

1. Because of her illness, the singer was unable to appear.
2. At the party, Bob asked his friend's sister for a dance.
3. When Betsy read *Romeo and Juliet* for the first time, she cried.
4. With their tickets in hand, the three sisters approached the gangplank.
5. Jean, will you read this poem aloud?
6. In spite of their accident, the actors arrived on time.
7. The lion snarled, opened its mouth, and roared.
8. Beethoven wrote his famous *Ninth Symphony* when he was deaf.
9. Grabbing his knee, the tackle collapsed on the grass.
10. Had she wanted, Sylvia could have won the first prize.

Exercise 2 Using Personal Pronouns in Sentences.

Fill in each blank with an appropriate personal pronoun.

EXAMPLE: Of all his operas, Verdi liked *Macbeth* the best.

1. Susan called _____ mother as soon as dancing class was over.
2. Without _____ helmets, the football team could not play.
3. Shakespeare returned to _____ home in Stratford often.
4. These flowers are so beautiful I wish _____ would bloom all year.
5. The wingspan of the frigate bird is the largest in proportion to _____ body.
6. Were you able to get _____ autographs?
7. I want you to ask for _____ passports now.
8. Marie and _____ have no spare time.
9. Have you prepared _____ welcoming speech yet?
10. I don't think I can take _____ coin collection with us.

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Pronouns (Antecedents of Pronouns, Personal Pronouns) • Practice 2

Exercise 1 **Recognizing Antecedents.** In each of the following sentences, a pronoun is underlined. Find the antecedent of each pronoun and circle it.

EXAMPLE: Somehow Jeff managed to lose his tuba.

1. There is a zoo in Arkansas that trains and houses a remarkable group of animals.
2. Visitors at the zoo can see such marvels as Bert Backquack and his all-duck band.
3. The zoo also includes among its residents a roller-skating parrot.
4. The trainers there believe that most animals behave intelligently if they are treated with respect.
5. Davy Crockett's tales made him a legend in his own time.
6. Davy went to Congress claiming that he had wrestled grizzly bears as a child.
7. Fashionable people found themselves competing for Davy's attention at parties.
8. As children, the Brontës created their own private world.
9. To avoid the prejudice against women who wrote, Charlotte and Emily Brontë took pen names.
10. Charlotte called herself Currer Bell, and her sister became Ellis Bell.

Exercise 2 **Identifying Personal Pronouns and Their Antecedents.** Each of the following sentences contains two personal pronouns. Underline each personal pronoun and circle its antecedent.

EXAMPLE: Jim, you forgot your hat.

1. Mom, you forgot to call your sister.
2. "I tried to repair my CD player," said Carlos.
3. Since Meg moved, she has called her friends once a week.
4. Now, boys, you have to clean up your own mess.
5. James tried to reach the doctor, but she was not in her office.
6. The brothers quit the team when they found that their grades were suffering.
7. Marge, yesterday you promised to lend your album to Judy.
8. The book is not as exciting as its jacket suggests, but it has one suspenseful chapter.
9. The McCurdys said that they would volunteer some of their time.
10. Uncle Dan gave his favorite watch to his oldest nephew.

Writing Application **Writing Sentences That Contain Personal Pronouns.** Write a short sentence using a personal pronoun that fits each description. Underline the pronoun you use.

EXAMPLE: third person, plural pronoun I folded the sheets and put them into the closet.

1. first person, singular pronoun

2. third person, singular, masculine pronoun

3. first person, plural pronoun

4. a different first person, plural pronoun

5. third person, singular, feminine pronoun

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Four Special Kinds of Pronouns**(Demonstrative and Relative Pronouns) • Practice 1**

Demonstrative Pronouns A demonstrative pronoun points out a specific person, place, or thing. There are four demonstrative pronouns, two singular and two plural.

DEMONSTRATIVE PRONOUNS	
Singular	Plural
this	these
that	those

Relative Pronouns A relative pronoun begins a subordinate clause and connects it to another idea in the same sentence. There are five relative pronouns.

RELATIVE PRONOUNS				
that	who	whose	which	whom

Exercise 1 **Recognizing Demonstrative and Relative Pronouns.** Circle the demonstrative or relative pronoun in each sentence. At the end of the sentence use a *D* to identify the pronoun as demonstrative or an *R* to identify it as relative. Note that the pronoun *that*, depending on use, can be either type.

EXAMPLE: (This) article is not correct. D

1. Unfortunately, these are now overripe tomatoes. _____
2. Picasso is the painter whom I most admire. _____
3. Are those your books? _____
4. The book that you reserved has not yet arrived. _____
5. Is this the map of Antarctica? _____
6. The woman who is in charge just left. _____
7. That is the last piece of chicken. _____
8. Of all her photos, those are the most original in concept. _____
9. Where is the man whose dog was found? _____
10. Father decided this was the most practical van. _____

Exercise 2 **Using Demonstrative and Relative Pronouns in Sentences.** Fill in each blank with an appropriate demonstrative or relative pronoun.

EXAMPLE: I wonder whom we will meet at the dance.

1. You must walk the dog each morning. _____ is your responsibility.
2. Where is the cake _____ she chose?
3. _____ has not worked properly for some time.
4. Do you know _____ the speaker will be?
5. You really have no choice. _____ are the rules.
6. Is Mary the girl _____ grandfather is visiting?
7. Take _____ and store them in the garage.
8. Is Sandy the girl _____ he likes?
9. Give us the design _____ the manager selected.
10. The senator, _____ will present the award, has just arrived.

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Four Special Kinds of Pronouns

(Demonstrative and Relative Pronouns) • Practice 2

Exercise 1 Recognizing Demonstrative Pronouns. Underline the demonstrative pronouns.

EXAMPLE: That is not the CD I would have chosen.

1. Those are the most expensive dresses in the store.
2. Of all the Beatles' records, these are their best.
3. She takes the trains; and that saves her time.
4. These are the three most popular exhibits.
5. Of all his ideas, those are the strangest.
6. This is the artist I want you to meet.
7. You may help by peeling carrots. That is your first chore.
8. He raises bromeliads. These are a kind of exotic plant.
9. That seems to be their busiest time of the year.
10. This was all she said before leaving: "I'll be back."
11. "Is this the first time you've been here?" asked the guide.
12. "I'd like to try a taste of that," said Amy, pointing to the pie.
13. These are the times that try men's souls.
14. Those were the days, my friend.
15. My advice to you is this: Calm down.
16. Are these your shoes?
17. If you lose that, you can find another one in the top drawer.
18. Holding out a bunch of daffodils, Daisy said, "I brought you these."
19. "That is not what I meant," said Prufrock.
20. "May I please see those?" asked Fran, looking into the display case.

Exercise 2 Recognizing Relative Pronouns. Underline the relative pronouns.

EXAMPLE: The person who left has just volunteered.

1. A leader whom our nation will never forget is Lincoln.
2. She chose a hat that matched her gown.
3. I will spend the summer vacation with my cousin who lives in Kingston.
4. The pipe that had leaked for a month finally burst.
5. The woman who was chosen scientist of the year works as a biochemist.
6. We joined the club whose introductory offer was the best.
7. The experimental car, which runs on batteries, does not pollute the air.
8. The pupil who gets the scholarship must excel in mathematics.
9. The dancer whom we admired most performed two solos.
10. Can you find a button that matches the others?
11. The birds that we saw at the zoo were flamingoes.
12. This hat, which I use when I go out into the snow, keeps my ears warm.
13. Cara, who will be here in an hour, is bringing the dessert.
14. Denise, whom we invited at the last minute, cannot come.
15. Albert is the boy whose bike you borrowed.

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Four Special Kinds of Pronouns**(Interrogative and Indefinite Pronouns) • Practice 1**

Interrogative Pronouns An interrogative pronoun is used to begin a question. There are five interrogative pronouns.

INTERROGATIVE PRONOUNS

what which who whom whose

Indefinite Pronouns Indefinite pronouns refer to people, places, or things, often without specifying which ones. There are many indefinite pronouns, some singular, some plural, and some either singular or plural.

INDEFINITE PRONOUNS

Singular	Plural	Singular or Plural
anyone	neither	both
each	no one	few
either	one	many
everything	other	others
everyone	somebody	several
		all;
		any
		more, most
		none
		some

Exercise 1 Recognizing Interrogative and Indefinite Pronouns. Circle the interrogative or indefinite pronoun. Identify interrogative pronouns with *int.* and indefinite pronouns with *ind.*

EXAMPLE: No one really knows our secret. *ind.*

- Who was chosen as our Homecoming Queen? _____
- Both of the suggestions are extremely helpful. _____
- Amazingly, Uncle Burt knew everyone at the dinner. _____
- The junior prom committee accepted one of our ideas. _____
- I found my jacket. Whose is still in the closet? _____
- My father knows somebody at the licensing bureau. _____
- Either of their choices is acceptable to the principal. _____
- Have you tried some of these fabulous desserts? _____
- Which is the shortest route to the stadium? _____
- Many of our friends will be going on the field trip. _____

Exercise 2 Using Interrogative and Indefinite Pronouns. Fill in each blank with an appropriate interrogative or indefinite pronoun.

EXAMPLE: I finally asked someone to help us.

- _____ is the eighth-grade assistant principal?
- The committee will examine _____ of their proposals.
- _____ of these books are too expensive for us.
- Can _____ enter this restricted area?
- There are several photographs. _____ is the best?
- Your information was wrong. _____ has to pay an entry fee.
- _____ of the original buildings still stand on Main Street.
- You know that _____ of H. G. Wells's predictions came true.
- With _____ do you expect to go to the party?
- _____ in the hall was delighted with Bill's performance.

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Four Special Kinds of Pronouns

(Interrogative and Indefinite Pronouns) • Practice 2

Exercise 1

Recognizing Interrogative Pronouns. Underline each interrogative pronoun.

EXAMPLE: Which of the colors goes best with this sweater?

- Which of Ernest Hemingway's novels takes place during the Spanish Civil War?
- One President of the United States served as Chief Justice of the Supreme Court after he left office.
Who was this President?
- What are the main differences between professional football and college football?
- Which is your favorite Joni Mitchell song?
- A special symbol is hidden in this painting. What is the symbol?
- Whom did Tom Sawyer and Becky Thatcher see when they were lost in the cave?
- Who pitched the only perfect game in the history of the World Series?
- What did Dorothy do to escape from the Wicked Witch of the West?
- Who was the first woman to be elected to the United States Congress?
- For whom did Lewis Carroll write *Alice's Adventures in Wonderland*?

Exercise 2

Recognizing Indefinite Pronouns. Each of the following sentences contains at least one indefinite pronoun. Underline the indefinite pronoun or pronouns in each sentence.

EXAMPLE: Nobody went to see that movie.

- Everyone applauded the winner of the marathon.
- The coach asked all the girls to prepare thoroughly for the match.
- Most of the students are interested in computers, but few know how they actually work.
- Few of my classmates knew anything about Susan B. Anthony.
- The auditorium was so dark that we could see nothing.
- Did someone remember to turn on the lights?
- Somebody has taken one of the dictionaries.
- Neither wanted to go, but it was important for both to attend.
- Little is known about the people who built Stonehenge.
- No one knew why some of the pages had been torn from his diary.

Writing Application

Writing Sentences With Pronouns. Write five sentences of your own using each of the different types of pronouns listed below. Underline the pronouns.

EXAMPLE: *who* as a relative pronoun. The room was crowded with people who were cheering.

- a singular demonstrative pronoun

- a plural demonstrative pronoun that comes after its antecedent

- that* as a relative pronoun.

- who* as a relative pronoun

- whose* as an interrogative pronoun
